



PARENT TEACHER ORGANIZATION



Dear A. Fantis Families,

We hope everyone had a restful and joyful Spring Break and Easter celebration! As we return to school, we are excited for the weeks ahead in our school community.

This month, we look forward to celebrating **After School Teacher Appreciation Week (April 20-24)**, a time to recognize the dedication and commitment our after school teachers bring to our children every single day. We are so grateful for them! At the beginning of May, we'll have **Teacher Appreciation Week (May 4-8)**. On both occasions, the PTO is preparing something special for our beloved educators.

Later this month, our students and faculty will proudly participate in the upcoming **Greek Independence Day Parade** in New York City, a tradition that honors our history, faith, and culture. See you there to walk with us behind the PTO banner on **Sunday, April 26**. No school the next day for PK3 and K-8!

Finally, we are eagerly preparing for our annual Gala, the **Derby Day Soiree on May 2**. This special evening brings our community together in support of our school's mission, and we look forward to celebrating with all of you.

As always, thank you for being such an important part of our school family. We are looking forward to all that lies ahead!

Warmly,

Your PTO Board

 Save the Dates

- ☐ **Fri, Apr 17:** A. Fantis 2026 Art Exhibition, Auditorium, 4-7pm
- ☐ **Mon, Apr 20 - Fri, Apr 24:** After School Teacher Appreciation Week
- ☐ **Fri, Apr 24:** Early dismissal; no after school clubs. Beyond the Bell available
- ☐ **Fri, Apr 24:** G4-8 Parent Executive Functioning Workshop, Auditorium, 8:45am
- ☐ **Sun, Apr 26:** Greek Independence Day parade - Parents walk behind the PTO banner
- ☐ **Mon, Apr 27:** No school for PK3 and K-8; camp available
- ☐ **Fri, May 1:** PreK Parent Workshop, Auditorium, 8:30am
- ☐ **Sat, May 2:** A.Fantis PTO Derby Day Soiree, 6-9pm - [Tickets on sale now](#)
- ☐ **Mon, May 4 - Fri, May 8:** Teacher Appreciation Week
- ☐ **Wed, May 6:** PTO Meeting on [Zoom](#), 8:30pm



Grab Tickets and Dress Your Best for Fantis Gala on May 2

We are pumped that this year's A. Fantis Gala is just around the corner! Join us for the Derby Day Soiree on Saturday, May 2 at the Fort Hamilton Distillery in Industry City, a venue that will set the perfect scene for a festive evening inspired by our Kentucky Derby theme. This 21+ fundraiser is the event of the year!

Tickets are officially [on sale now](#), and we encourage you not to miss your chance to enjoy a wonderful night of community, celebration, and support for our school. From great company and music to exciting auction items (some available during the gala only, like tickets for the Fantis Night at the Cyclones), it promises to be a truly special evening! If you can't attend,

please consider sponsoring tickets for a teacher or a staff member. The cost of the tickets covers the cost of the gala! The more tickets that are sold, the more money goes back to the school. Grab [tickets for yourself and/or sponsor teachers](#) today! **Last day to purchase tickets and sponsorships is April 29.** Tickets will not be sold at the door.

Support Our Teachers & Staff

All A. Fantis faculty and staff are invited to attend the Gala free of charge, but sponsoring their attendance makes a meaningful difference.

- Total cost to cover all 45 staff members: \$6,750
- Sponsorships start at \$25
- Class collections (as little as \$10 per family) can sponsor a teacher. Organize this yourself or talk to your Class Parent

While all teachers are invited, it's especially meaningful when they know their spot was sponsored by their class or families - it often encourages even more of them to attend!

[Sponsor a staff member here](#)

Help Gather Auction Items

We are actively seeking donations of experiences and special one-of-a-kind items to make our auction exciting and irresistible. Think restaurant gift cards, classes, museum memberships, camp credits, wellness services, tickets, unique experiences, or specialty products. If it's fun, useful, delicious, or uniquely New York, it's a great fit!

Your favorite coffee shop, your kids' favorite activity and clubs, and your go-to for date nights are most likely willing to donate - all you have to do is ask! In addition, class parties are a huge hit too - donate pizza, cupcakes, ice cream, donuts, a craft - use your creativity! More ideas are [here](#); use this [form](#) to add your donation. **Last day to submit auction items is April 24.**

Become a Sponsor

We also invite you to consider becoming an **event sponsor**. Opportunities range from small alumni contributions to larger sponsorship packages that include gala tickets and recognition during the event and on our auction platform. Alumni Bonus - if you (or your child) are a Fantis alumni, sponsorships over \$150 will be entered into a raffle!

[Auction Item Donation Form](#)

[Gala Sponsorship Information & Donation Letter](#)

This year's goal is to raise at least **\$20,000** for the facilities fund in order to improve the second-floor auditorium, from the stage & sound system to the floors & water fountains. We also hope to use some funds for the classrooms as well!

Help The Night Of

If you are able to help the night of the gala, please let us know [here](#). Even 30 minutes or an hour makes all the difference. We really appreciate it!

What to Wear

This year's Kentucky Derby theme adds a fun twist to the evening! Think:

- Floral dresses, pastels, or bold spring colors
- Statement hats or fascinators
- Light suits, blazers, or bow ties

Whether you go all out or keep it simple, feel free to embrace the spirit.

Thank you for helping create a wonderful evening for Fantis. If you have questions or ideas, we'd love to hear from you! Find us at drop-off/pick-up, or reach out at pto@afantis.org.

Next Week is After School Teacher Appreciation Week

This year's After School Teacher Appreciation Week is April 20-24. It is a special time for our school community to recognize and celebrate our incredible after school teachers. Their dedication, energy, and care extend well beyond the regular school day, creating a nurturing and enriching environment where our children continue to learn, grow, and thrive. We are truly grateful for their creativity, commitment, and important role they play in our students' daily lives, and this week is a wonderful opportunity to thank them for all that they do:

- **Connor Wright** - After School Director
- **Mila Reeves** - After School Assistant Director (typically dismissal and PreK, K-1)
- **Dominique Stevens** - PreK
- **Chelsea Gourdet** - PreK, K-1
- **Leandra Desuze** - typically PreK
- **Devon Caban** - typically PreK
- **Cait Henneberry** - typically G4-8
- **Pat Davis** - typically G4-8
- **Maria Hohlastos** - typically K-3
- **Matina Demeli** - typically 2nd-3rd, but also K-1 and G4-8
- **Abby Bettencourt** - typically G3-3, but also G4-8

Please consider writing a card and saying a special thank-you at pickup. The PTO will have something special for them, too.



PTO supports Greek Independence Day Parade

The PTO is proud to support our community's participation in the annual **Greek Independence Day Parade on Sun, April 26!** This special event is a wonderful opportunity to celebrate Greek heritage, honor tradition, and come together as a school community. We encourage all families to join us in showing their A. Fantis pride, walking with us up 5th Avenue behind the PTO banner. Wear blue or black, and no jeans, please! All details about bus time from the school to Manhattan, as well as our time to join the parade, are shared by the school.

We look forward to celebrating together!

Join Us for Greek Festival Food Prep

The Greek Festival may be in early June, but food prep is at full speed. And it's time to make one of everyone's favorites: spanakopita! Volunteers will be gathering in the church kitchen **today (Wed, April 15) and Friday (April 17) from 9am-2pm**, and again at the same time on **Wednesday and Friday next week (April 22 and 24)**. If you're able to stop by for even an hour, your help would make a big difference. It's also a great way to connect and be part of this beloved tradition. We hope to see you there!

Support Fantis with RaiseRight

With **RaiseRight**, every gift card you buy — whether it's for morning coffee, weekly groceries, or last-minute items — earns money for A. Fantis. It's the easiest way to support our teachers and students without additional cost.

There are 750+ participating brands, including Target, Sephora, American Express, and Hilton. View the full brand list [here](#)!

Setting it up takes just a minute:

- 1) Visit RaiseRight.com/Enroll
- 2) Enter the code **6KPJTVYVYN9X** to link to **A. Fantis**
- 3) Download the app and start shopping!

Tip: Use RaiseRight gift cards when buying items from teachers' wish lists or classroom economy supplies - you'll give back twice in one purchase!

More Ways to Shop, Save & Support Fantis

Did you know you can **save money AND support A. Fantis at the same time**? Our yearlong fundraisers make it easy: shop for exclusive discounts, and a portion of every purchase goes right back to our school programs.

- **1st Place Spirit Gear:** Show off your school pride. Our [1st Place Spirit Gear](#) is now always available, and every order helps fund PTO initiatives.
 - **Mabel's Labels:** Durable name labels for gear and clothes. Search our school at www.mabelslabels.com and save on replacing lost items. 20% of all purchases support the PTO.
 - **Minted:** Get 20% off cards, gifts & more with code FUNDRAISEAFANTIS while Fantis earns 10% back! Go to www.minted.com.
 - **Squadlocker:** Show off your school pride. Our [Squadlocker](#) Spirit gear is always available, and every order helps fund PTO initiatives.
 - **Shoott:** Use [our special link](#) to book your photo session, and a portion of the proceeds will come back to A. Fantis.
 - **Box Top\$:** Buy the brands you already love and earn \$5 for A. Fantis. Learn how to earn using this [link](#) and browse all participating brands [here](#).
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In Case You Missed It

Here are some of the PTO initiatives from the past month! To be in the know, keep an eye on our emails, Bloomz posts (including albums), and the **PTO Corner** in the *This Week at Fantis* weekly newsletter for the latest updates and opportunities to get involved. You can lend a hand at events or share your ideas and [talents](#). Stay up to date through the [School Calendar](#) and the [PTO Linktree](#), and reach us anytime at pto@afantis.org.



PTO In-Person Meeting + Uniform Sale - Thanks to all who attended our second in-person meeting of the year at the school gym on March 27. The uniform sale was a hit with the Spring uniform change and generated \$495 towards our Spring initiatives. If you want to know more, the meeting notes are [here](#).

Greek Independence Day Show - Our little students did a wonderful job performing at the Greek Independence Day show on March 19, with a special recital by the 4th and 6th grades. The PTO thanked the Hellenic department & the Prek-G2 faculty with gifts. Thank you for a lovely presentation.

PTO Best Seats Auction for PK-G2 Greek Independence Day Show - Parents have been demonstrating that they like the chance to access front-row seats for special performances through the PTO's Best Seats Auctions. For the March 19 show, the auction generated \$312 towards our Spring initiatives. Thanks to all who participated